Response Tactics & Response Friction Score (RFS)

Version 1.0.0 · 2026-10-23

Editors of the Great House Farm Legal Wiki

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Page 3714 of the Great House Farm Legal Wiki, carried over from the version last modified on 2026-10-20. The same page is published at research.bucklerfamily.estate, and this version is also a PDF in the wayback archive.

1 Release notes

1.1 This release (version 1.0.0)

- **2026-Oct-23** - Carried over to the docs library from Legal Wiki page 3714 (last modified 2026-10-20 15:37:51 UTC). The page text, dates and references are as on the wiki. Links to wiki pages lead to the same page on research.bucklerfamily.estate; images are links to their files on the wiki.

1.2 Older versions

None yet.

2 Record

This material now lives at https://fcg.bucklerfamily.estate/case/response-tactics-response-friction-score**.**

Page ID: 3714 · **Title:** Response Tactics & Response Friction Score (RFS) · **Evidence status:** Corrected 18 Oct 2026; evidence labels on the edited lines · **Version:** 1.0.1 · Editing Protocol

Purpose. This register tests the "three-hat" model (procedural holding response; defensive or scope-shifting response; high-friction use of delay, cost, confidentiality or remit) against the wording of actual public correspondence about Great House Farm / Tŷ Mawr, Llandough and the Williams/Buckler family. It scores individual messages, not whole institutions or people.

Label: the published term is **Response Friction Score (RFS)**. It measures observable difficulty in getting a clear, relevant and usable answer. It is not a rating of a person's character, a finding of misconduct, or proof of concealment or unlawful behaviour. A lawful refusal can still be high-friction; an honest "not held" response can be low-friction.

2.1 Scoring rule: five dimensions, each 0–2

- **Answer completeness:** 0 = directly answers the question; 1 = partly answers or needs follow-up; 2 = substitutes a previous answer, closes the exchange without addressing the material question, or leaves a central point unanswered.
- **Scope discipline:** 0 = tracks the request; 1 = an arguable mismatch or unclear interpretation; 2 = a substantial reframing or wider search basis without showing why it is necessary.
- **Search, estimate or record-method transparency:** 0 = gives a usable explanation; 1 = some relevant method is missing; 2 = important method is unexplained, internally unclear, or cannot be tested from the reply.
- **Withholding / legal-basis clarity:** 0 = explains whether material is held, withheld or absent and identifies the basis; 1 = broad or partly ambiguous explanation; 2 = unclear whether information is held or withheld, or a legal basis is asserted without enough particulars to understand its application.
- **Timeliness, assistance and next steps:** 0 = on time (or a clearly explained holding update with a usable route); 1 = a missed or vague commitment or a partial next step; 2 = a verified missed deadline or promised date with no firm revised date or adequate explanation. Score delay only after checking the correct statutory clock, clarification pauses, extensions and source chronology.

Interpretation: 0–2 low friction; 3–4 limited friction; 5–6 material friction; 7–8 high friction; 9–10 very high friction. A component should be scored only where the source supports it. The total is a reproducible editorial aid, not a legal test or probability that wrongdoing occurred. Confidence is recorded separately.

2.2 Force, Secrecy and Licence: tagging lens

- **Force:** tag only if the wording shows an express threat, compulsion, sanction or actual use of coercive power. A statutory citation alone is not "force".
- **Secrecy:** tag when the message relies on withholding, neither-confirm-nor-deny treatment, privacy/confidentiality, restricted access or a missing decision trail. The tag describes the information effect, not motive.
- **Licence:** tag when the response relies on a statutory threshold, exemption, cost limit, procedural rule, discretionary remit or institutional power. This can be entirely legitimate; the relevant question is whether its application is explained and fits the request.

Each assessment also records mitigating features, source quality and the next document needed. Where a reply or attachment has not been inspected, it is listed as *unscored*, not assigned a hostile score by assumption.

2.3 Initial source-reviewed scores — 18 October 2026

2.3.1 1. Llandough Community Council — quoted wording attributed to 20 September 2026

RFS 7/10 — high friction; low confidence. The quoted wording says the Clerk had already directed the requester to information held and "We have nothing more to add." This appears to close the exchange rather than respond to the later itemised question about records created after the 2002 archive deposit, photographs and what records transferred in 1982. The original 20 September email has not been separately recovered: the wording is preserved as a quote in later correspondence, so score only the quotation, not the missing message's full context.

Tags: closure without a fresh answer; reliance on a prior response. **Power lens:** no Force evidence; the quote has a closure effect, but without the original message it is not enough to infer deliberate secrecy. **Next step:** retain the 28 September email containing the quote and obtain the original 20 September message if available.

Source-status note: quoted reply, not recovered original · Open Council correspondence thread.

2.3.2 2. Llandough Community Council Chair — 28 September 2026 forwarding reply

RFS 1/10 — low friction; medium confidence. The published transcription states that the 21 September email had been passed to the Clerk for consideration. That is a holding/forwarding message, not a substantive answer or refusal.

The transcription is not the original .eml and does not include the original headers. It should not be treated as evidence of evasion on its own.

Tags: routing / holding reply. **Power lens:** none clearly evidenced in this message. **Next step:** assess against the later substantive response, not in isolation.

Source: Council reply transcription · Open Council correspondence thread.

2.3.3 3. Llandough Community Council Clerk — section 12 refusal, 11 October 2026

RFS 5/10 — material friction; medium confidence. The 16 October response is available as a Wayback transcription, but the current GHF-E184 wiki page explicitly says the original thread, complete headers and attachments have not yet been captured there. The letter invokes section 12, gives the £450 / 18-hour limit, estimates 224 sets of minutes for 2002–2016, says "about 20 minutes to read each set" and "about 10 minutes to assess each set", then states a total of over 2,240 minutes (about 37 hours). The calculation appears to use 10 minutes per set; it does not explain whether the 20- and 10-minute figures are alternatives or cumulative. This is a precise, testable question about the stated method, not proof the refusal is unlawful.

The letter's mitigating features must remain on the record: it identifies section 12, states the £450 threshold and staff-time rate, proposes narrowing the date range (for example 2002–2006), and gives an internal-review route and the right to complain to the ICO. The proper challenge is to ask how the estimate was constructed, what activities were counted and why the narrow confirm/deny questions require review of all 224 sets. Do not claim that section 12 automatically fails because an estimate is not perfectly itemised; the ICO says no precise calculation is always required, but estimates should be sensible and realistic and advice/assistance should be considered.

Tags: statutory cost threshold; estimate method needs clarification; possible scope-fit issue. **Power lens:** Licence (statutory cost power); no evidence of Force. **Next step:** ask for the calculation and search tasks that produce the estimate, then test the response against ICO section 12 and section 16 guidance.

Source: 11 October refusal transcription · Open Council correspondence thread · ICO section 12 guidance · ICO section 16 guidance.

2.3.4 4. Heneb HER Team — schedule response, 16 October 2026

RFS 6/10 — material friction; high confidence in the transcribed email. The reply addresses a 48-point schedule, uses public-availability pointers for some items, gives many itemised "not held" answers, explains that the HER change log does not store snapshots of table contents, and says predecessor HER paper records are held at Baglan. Items 3–5 remain unclear: the HER says its change log does not store snapshots, then says it cannot release "this information" because it contains personal data. The wording does not distinguish cleanly between no snapshot existing and information being held but withheld. Score vector [1,0,1,2,1] = 5/10. GHF-E184 states that the source page remains transcript-pending, so this is a medium-confidence score, not a claim that the original email was recovered.

This is not a finding that the data-protection position is invalid. The follow-up should ask Heneb to distinguish "not held / no snapshot exists" from "held but withheld", identify the categories of personal data and legal basis relied on for items 3–5, and say whether a redacted or non-personal extract is possible. The 48 numbered replies and the stated archive location are mitigating features.

Tags: held-versus-withheld ambiguity; broad data-protection explanation; public pointer not direct copy. **Power lens:** Secrecy (data-protection / snapshot limitation) and Licence (claimed legal basis); no evidence of Force.

Source: Heneb HER email, 16 October · Open referenced correspondence thread.

2.3.5 5. Amgueddfa Cymru — Museum Wales — 7 October 2026

RFS 1/10 — low friction; medium confidence. The public text archive preserves a transcription, not the original .eml. The Museum said it did not hold a separate item-by-item audit schedule of excluded search results, explained that staff reviewed results for relevance and that the decision outcome was reflected in the 5 October response, then answered the MS 3360/3 and waterwheel-location points. The absence of an audit schedule matters as a record-keeping limitation, but the reply openly acknowledges it and gives a usable explanation rather than hiding it.

Tags: no separate contemporaneous search schedule (record gap, not proof of evasion). **Power lens:** none clearly indicated by this email. **Assessment:** the disclosure that a log does not exist reduces response friction even though it leaves a gap in the evidence trail.

Source: Museum Wales email, 7 October · Open Museum Wales correspondence thread.

2.3.6 6. Amgueddfa Cymru — Museum Wales — 8 October 2026

RFS 1/10 — low friction; medium confidence. The public text archive preserves a transcription, not the original .eml.

The reply explains that there is no catalogue record identifying Great House Farm within MS 3360/3; Collections staff identified and supplied one relevant page after additional research; and no further recorded information was found within the material held under that reference. “Nothing further to add” is paired with a substantive explanation here, so it is not scored like the Council’s stand-alone quoted closure.

Source: Museum Wales email, 8 October · Open Museum Wales correspondence thread.

2.3.7 7. Amgueddfa Cymru — Museum Wales — 12 October 2026

RFS 1/10 — low friction; medium confidence. The public text archive preserves a transcription, not the original .eml. The Museum directly states that it does not hold a separate search log, file note, internal note or other recorded document explaining the FOI 2026-024 scope assessment. It gives a retrospective explanation of the searches and why other finds were treated as outside the narrowly described discovery, says Church Farm records have since been supplied, and confirms “No records remain withheld.” The absent contemporaneous rationale is a record gap, but the reply plainly admits that gap and describes its reasoning.

Tags: no contemporaneous decision record; retrospective explanation. **Power lens:** none clearly indicated by this message. Low RFS does not mean the missing rationale is immaterial; it means the reply is direct about it.

Source: Museum Wales email, 12 October · Open Museum Wales review thread.

2.4 Not scored yet — evidence needed first

- **South Wales Police FOI 1040/26:** the correspondence catalogue says Response 1040_26.pdf was attached to the reply; the attachment has not been reviewed here. Do not score the substantive response from the cover email alone.
- **Heneb / HER, 22 May:** the current GHF-E188 page is explicitly a catalogue summary with transcript pending. Do not score the assertion that Heneb was not subject to FOI requests until the exact original request and reply are captured and whether FOIA, EIR or both were invoked is checked.
- **Ministry of Defence:** the current chart summarises a section 23(5) neither-confirm-nor-deny response and a SAR “no information in scope” answer, but the source body has not been reviewed for this scoring exercise. An NCND position is opaque by design and may be lawful; it is not in itself proof of misconduct.
- **HM Land Registry:** F260213.pdf is attached to the 13 April cover email but has not been reviewed in this pass. The 13 March title-number correspondence is scored separately; the underlying request and F260213.pdf must be read together for a final merits assessment.
- **Vale of Glamorgan Scrutiny:** the refusal is currently represented by a summary. Score only after reviewing the original message and the remit/policy it relies upon.
- **NaCTSO:** “new response” notifications are not the response bodies. Do not infer what they said.
- **National Library of Wales acknowledgement (15 October):** it says the service has high demand and some resource challenges and warns of possible delay. That is a transparent acknowledgement, not yet an overdue substantive response. Do not score delay before the applicable response time or promised update has passed.
- **Council internal review / agenda thread:** the later-updated GHF-E183 Council chronology records a 13 October 20:09 Clerk acknowledgement and an agenda exchange on 13–14 October, but says the original acknowledgement body is not separately transcribed. The substantive internal-review outcome remains unconfirmed; check the applicable deadline and original acknowledgement before scoring further delay.

2.5 How to keep the register fair and useful

- Score a specific message and, where needed, a linked thread; do not give every email from one institution the same rating.
- Mark the source as original, full transcription, quotation, summary or automatic acknowledgement. Lower confidence when the original or attachments are missing.
- Keep two separate findings: *response friction* and *record gap*. A candid admission that no search log exists may identify an important record gap while still earning a low friction score.
- Use time-based delay flags only after the actual due date, including extensions or clarification pauses where relevant, is verified.

- Re-score when the institution clarifies the calculation, supplies records, corrects an error, or an original message is recovered. Keep the old score and reason for change in the audit trail.
- Do not infer collusion, fraud, concealment or hostile intent from the score alone. Those are separate allegations requiring independent evidence.

2.6 Official guidance used for the legal comparison

- ICO: section 12 — cost of compliance. The ICO says estimates need to be sensible and realistic; the £450/18-hour limit applies to most public authorities, with staff time estimated at £25/hour, and advice/refocusing should be considered.
- ICO: section 16 — advice and assistance.
- ICO: section 17 — refusal notices. The ICO notes that there is no statutory requirement for a section 12 notice to include the estimate, but a clear explanation and breakdown can help the requester understand how the limit is said to apply.

Coverage limit: this register now scores 20 assessed message items across nine organisations/teams. It is not a score for every one of the 585 items indexed in Wayback, and those objects are not all independently verified as emails or original .eml files. Expand systematically as original messages and attachments are read; do not fill gaps with assumptions.

2.7 Second-pass source audit — current wiki state checked 18 October 2026

This second pass incorporates the later-updated wiki records, particularly GHF-E183/GHF-E184, the 14 October Heneb digitisation notice, the 16 October Museum Wales follow-up, the Vale Council internal-review chronology and the 12 October South Wales Police acknowledgement. The vector shown is in this order: **answer completeness / scope discipline / search-method transparency / withholding-basis clarity / timeliness-assistance**; each dimension is 0–2 and the sum is RFS /10. These are 13 additional scored message items, taking the scored sample to 20. A public transcription or catalogue entry is not represented as an original .eml.

2.7.1 8. Heneb HER — 6 October source-file reply

RFS 3/10 — limited friction; medium confidence. Heneb directed the requester to freely available Archwilio record 02038s, noted that the specific additional source questions would require further time, and promised a separate reply. Vector: **[1,0,1,0,1] = 3**. Source: 6 October Wayback transcription. The later 14 October digitisation notice matters: the 6 October deferral should not be assessed as though the later disclosure never happened. GHF-E183 says the original thread remains pending in the evidence page, so this is not a recovered original email.

2.7.2 9. Heneb HER — 14 October source-file digitisation notice

RFS 1/10 — low friction; medium confidence. The message states that the HER source file had been digitised and uploaded to Archwilio as PDFs under record 02038s, and says this completes provision of material previously held only in the physical file. Vector: **[0,0,1,0,0] = 1**. Source: 14 October Wayback transcription. A physical-file check is not stated in the available transcript; the digitisation notice does not prove that historic HER change-log snapshots exist.

2.7.3 10. Amgueddfa Cymru — Museum Wales — 16 October search-detail follow-up

RFS 3/10 — limited friction; medium confidence. The Museum repeated that it had previously described the searches, listed place-name and associated searches, clarified that the earliest accession-register searches included former Cardiff Museum records that became part of the National Museum collection without re-accessioning, and said there was no separate search log or further recorded detail. Vector: **[1,0,1,0,1] = 3**. Source: 16 October Wayback transcription. This is not scored as an unexplained refusal: it gives some added information and candidly identifies a record gap, although it does not supply every search term/system requested.

2.7.4 11. Amgueddfa Cymru — Museum Wales — 14 August search-method explanation

RFS 1/10 — low friction; medium confidence. The reply identifies CMS, accession files, donor and location indexes, archived electronic records and specific search terms including Great House Farm, Tŷ Mawr, Llandough, Buckler and Bute, and explains why the no-records response remained unchanged. Vector: **[0,0,0,0,1] = 1**. Source: Museum Wales

correspondence catalogue. This is a useful counterexample to the hypothesis that every records refusal is secretive: the search method is made more testable and an internal-review route is given.

2.7.5 12. Vale of Glamorgan Council — EIR 00210772, 7 July

RFS 1/10 — low friction; medium confidence. The Council specified the search area (including Church View Close, north side of Leckwith Road and title WA231076), the period from 1875 where records existed, pointed to planning-register records, identified categories said not to be held and asked for clarification of the particular GIS datasets sought. Vector: **[0,0,0,0,1] = 1**. Source: Vale Council correspondence catalogue. The exact EIR clock should be calculated from the 7 June clarification date before any delay allegation is made. The response gives specific grounds and routes rather than simply closing the request.

2.7.6 13. Vale of Glamorgan Council — 5 August delayed-update message

RFS 3/10 — limited friction; medium confidence. The Council apologised for delay, said service-area enquiries remained incomplete and promised a further update by Friday 14 August. That commitment was later acknowledged as missed in the 11 September correspondence. Vector: **[1,0,1,0,1] = 3**. Source: Vale Council correspondence catalogue. The promise and later miss are observable; they do not establish deliberate stalling.

2.7.7 14. Vale of Glamorgan Council — 11 September internal-review status

RFS 4/10 — material friction; medium confidence. After the 14 August promised update was missed, the Council apologised, reported that further historical documentation had been found, and said it was still being sifted for relevance and might require third-party consultation. It did not give a firm revised completion date. Vector: **[1,0,1,0,2] = 4**. Source: Vale Council correspondence catalogue. The missed commitment raises the timeliness score, while the explanation and disclosure that more records were found mitigate the score.

2.7.8 15. Cadw — 29 July review reply, ATISN 27021

RFS 3/10 — limited friction; medium confidence. Cadw referred back to earlier July replies, stated records had been checked, said it held no further information or record of destruction, and distinguished an inspector's experience-based understanding of usual transfer/destruction practice from any located transfer lists or archive schedules. Vector: **[1,0,1,0,1] = 3**. Source: Welsh Government/Cadw correspondence catalogue. Missing transfer records are a record gap, not proof of deliberate concealment.

2.7.9 16. South Wales Police — FOI 1264/26 acknowledgement, 12 October

RFS 0/10 — very low friction; medium confidence. The officer acknowledged the named request and expressly set the response deadline as 9 November 2026. That date had not passed as at the 18 October review cut-off. Vector: **[0,0,0,0,0] = 0**. Source: South Wales Police correspondence catalogue, part 3. Do not treat a timely acknowledgement as an evasive non-answer; rescore the substantive reply when it arrives or the deadline passes.

2.7.10 17. National Library of Wales — acknowledgement, ticket 9890384

RFS 1/10 — low friction; medium confidence. The acknowledgement confirms receipt, supplies ticket 9890384, says high demand and resource challenges may delay replies, and promises an update without a date. Vector: **[0,0,0,0,1] = 1**. Source: LibAnswers acknowledgement transcription. This is not yet evidence of overdue handling; the source timestamps straddle 15 October UTC / 16 October BST and should not be confused with a substantive-response deadline.

2.7.11 18. Crown Prosecution Service — 29 September case-file identification reply

RFS 2/10 — low friction; medium confidence. The CPS says it cannot locate a case file from the information supplied and explains the use of a Unique Reference Number. Vector: **[1,0,1,0,0] = 2**. Source: CPS correspondence catalogue. This is a request for a useful identifier, not an information-withholding ground; score it again only if later exchanges show the route was circular or impossible to follow.

2.7.12 19. Crown Prosecution Service — 8 October holding reply

RFS 2/10 — low friction; medium confidence. The CPS apologised for the late acknowledgement, said the email had been passed to a manager for advice and promised to return after receiving that advice, without a firm date. Vector: **[1,0,0,0,1] = 2**. Source: CPS correspondence catalogue. This is a holding response with an explained escalation route, not a substantive outcome or proof of concealment.

2.7.13 20. HM Land Registry — 13 March 2026 title-number prerequisite

RFS 2/10 — low friction; medium confidence. HM Land Registry said it could not proceed with FOI F260213 without a title number, explaining that the information supplied had not identified one and directing the requester to Customer Support for help locating the relevant title. Vector: **[1,1,0,0,0] = 2**. Source: HMLR/ICR correspondence catalogue, part 2. This is recorded as a procedural prerequisite, not as evidence of a secretive or unlawful refusal; a final assessment should read the original request and any later F260213 attachment alongside it.

Current sample total: 20 assessed message items. Nine organisations/teams are represented in this scored sample. It is still not a score for every record indexed by Wayback, and it is not a set of twenty independently recovered original .eml files. The current draft-review page and Gmail inventory also remain separate from this response scoring exercise.

Change history is maintained on the Master Change Log; no separate page-local version footer is maintained.